On April 4, I had received an unusual piece of mail—a package that turned out to be a complimentary copy of The Best of Science Fiction, with "Blind Alley" included in it. Once again, a small memory of older, happier days assailed me.

The pressures to which it gave rise built up within me. On April 10, I dug out the first draft of "Evidence," which I still had, but which I had done nothing with for nearly two months. Since I was a clerk-typist with nothing, at the moment, to type, I put the entire eight thousand words into final copy on that day.

The next day I went to the post office in Honolulu and mailed it off to Campbell—airmail, registered, return receipt requested—for $1.70. I asked him, if he took the story, to send the check to Gertrude.

He did take it and he did send the check to Gertrude. The check arrived on April 20 and I got word of it from her on April 29. What's more, the story was paid for at the new high rate of a full $.02 a word, so that the check came to $160.

9

On April 15, I attended a Passover Seder given at McKinley High School in Honolulu. There was a $2.00 charge for civilians, but it was free to servicemen. It was the first Seder I had attended since my father's, eighteen years before.

I enjoyed it tremendously. Heroically and steadily, I plowed through the endless supply of good things to eat. In addition, there was sweet port wine at each table into which all could dip, ad lib—and since that is by all odds my favorite form of liquor (when I can bring myself to drink any at all), I ad libbed quite a bit.

I was as high as a kite in no time, and by the time I made my way home, I sloshed as I moved.

I walked into the barracks compound singing Passover songs quite loudly and made considerable noise as I got into the barracks itself. Several of the boys, particularly Dylewski, woke up at once and demanded to know who it was. I was the only one absent and I didn't drink, so the obviously drunken swine who was staggering from one bed to the other couldn't be me.

"It's me," I called out happily. "Is that you, Stash?" (That was the diminutive